

**AGREEMENT COVERING
CLASSIFIED EMPLOYEES
FOR**

2022 – 2023

2023 – 2024

2024 – 2025

2025 – 2026

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ARTICLE I

RECOGNITION

A. RECOGNITION

The Board of Education of AlWood Community Unit School District #225, Henry, Knox, and Mercer Counties, Illinois (hereinafter referred to as the "Board" or "Employer") hereby recognizes the AlWood Education Association/IEA/NEA (hereinafter referred to as the "Association" or the "A.E.A.") as the sole and exclusive bargaining representative for all full-time and part-time certificated or professional, non-supervisory personnel (hereinafter referred to as "Certificated Employee" or "Teacher") and all full-time and part-time non-certificated personnel (hereinafter referred to as "Classified Employee"). The term "Employee" shall refer to any individual represented by the AEA, and specific Classified Employee positions shall be referred to by job title, e.g., custodian, secretary, etc. Such representation shall exclude the superintendent, principals, superintendent's secretary, bookkeeper and all other supervisors, managerial, confidential or short-term employees as defined by the Illinois Educational Labor Relations Act.

B. INDIVIDUAL CONTRACTS

All contracts with the Classified Employees employed by AlWood Schools, with the exception of substitutes, shall be in writing and signed by the officers of the Board of Education as provided by law. Any individual contracts given Classified Employees shall not conflict with any express provisions of this Agreement.

C. BINDING OBLIGATION

The provisions of this Agreement shall constitute a binding obligation of the parties for the duration of this agreement or until changed by written mutual consent. Any previously adopted policy, rule, or regulation of the parties that is in conflict with a provision of this Agreement shall be superseded and replaced by this Agreement.

ARTICLE II

ASSOCIATION RIGHTS

A. MEETINGS

The Association may conduct Association business, including formal and informal meetings, at any time during the work day that attending members are not directly responsible for student supervision or other school-related activities, provided that the Association meetings have been scheduled on the District calendar.

B. USE OF FACILITIES AND EQUIPMENT

The Association shall have the right to reasonable use of District facilities and equipment for the purpose of conducting Association business, provided that such equipment is not being used for school matters and the use is not disruptive to school routine. The Association agrees to pay for consumable materials.

C. ASSOCIATION BUSINESS

The District shall grant an aggregate of three (3) days annually for Association business. Use of such days must be requested of the Superintendent. Such days may be used in whole or half days and may be used by more than one (1) person. The District shall pay for the substitute, but it shall not pay for the expenses of the Classified Employee(s) on Association business.

D. ASSOCIATION REPRESENTATIVES AND AGENTS

Authorized agents of the Association, upon notifying the Building Principal's office, may meet with a Classified Employee (or group of Classified Employees) in the school building before and after the Classified Employee's work day and during the Classified Employee's duty-free lunch period or non-working period.

E. DUES DEDUCTIONS

1. The Board shall deduct local, state and national union dues from the wages of union members.
2. Such fees shall be paid to the Association by the Board no later than thirty (30) days following deduction.
3. In the event of any legal action against the Employer brought in a court or administrative agency because of its compliance with this Article, the Association agrees to defend such action, at its own expense and through its own counsel, provided:
 - a. The Employer gives immediate notice of such action in writing to the Association, and permits the Association intervention as a party if it so desires; and,
 - b. The Employer gives full and complete cooperation to the Association and its counsel in securing and giving evidence, obtaining witnesses and making relevant information available at both trial and all appellate levels.
4. The Association agrees that in any action so defended, it will indemnify and hold harmless the Employer from any liability for damages and costs imposed by a

final judgment of a court or administrative agency as a direct consequence of the Employer's non-negligent compliance with this Article.

It is expressly understood that this save harmless provision will not apply to any claim, demand, suit or other form of liability which may arise as a result of any type of willful misconduct by the Board or the Board's imperfect execution of the obligations imposed upon it by this Article.

ARTICLE III

EMPLOYEE WORKING CONDITIONS

A. ADMINISTRATIVE AND BOARD SUPPORT

The Board shall protect and hold harmless non-certified employees from liability in the performance of their duties while in the scope of their employment.

B. SCHOOL CALENDAR AND WORK YEAR

The school calendar shall consist of not more than one hundred eighty-five (185) days of which not more than one hundred eighty (180) shall be student attendance and institute days. The remaining five (5) days will be used as emergency days as determined by the Employer. Classified Employees whose work year is based upon student attendance days shall not be required to report to work on these five (5) days. Other Classified Employees are to report to work as soon as safely possible on days when school is not in session due to emergency. Work hours missed may be made up to avoid loss of pay. The maximum work year for Classified Employees shall be as follows:

1. Twelve (12) Month Employees. Full-time custodians, bus mechanics, and maintenance personnel work daily and a work week of forty (40) hours, with the individual time schedule developed by the administration, and subject to individual building needs. Custodians assume the additional responsibility for building checks as outlined in their job description.
2. Ten (10) Month Employees. Full-time secretarial/clerical employees shall work a minimum of one hundred ninety (190) days, except in the case of a strike. On days when school sessions are canceled due to emergency situations and certificated personnel are not required to report for work, ten (10) month Classified Employees will not be required to work. Full-time secretarial/clerical employees will have a work week of forty (40) hours, with the individual time schedule developed by the building principal.
3. School-Year Employees. All other Classified Employees will work the school calendar year unless a different schedule is developed for an individual

Classified Employee by the administration, e.g., library aide working book fair, etc.

4. The health aide will be compensated for school physicals provided during the summer at the current hourly health aide rate.

5. The parent coordinator will be compensated for evening parent meetings at the hourly parent coordinators rate.

Notwithstanding the preceding provisions, the Board shall retain the right to make reductions in force pursuant to Section 10-23.5 of the School Code.

C. WORK HOURS/ON-CALL WORK

Full-time custodians, bus mechanics, maintenance employees, and secretarial/clerical employees have a work day of eight (8) hours. Classroom aides work a schedule subject to building needs as determined by the Building Principal and subject to the provisions of this Agreement. Work hours for aides may be changed to meet student and District needs. All other Classified Employees work on hourly schedules as established and approved by the administration, e.g., head cook providing the breakfast program at Alpha, head cooks completing required paper work, etc. at the sole discretion of the Principal. Fridays and the day before a holiday, Classified Employees other than the bus mechanic, bus drivers and custodians may leave after all students have left.

A maintenance, custodial or mechanic employee who is on call may be called to work after leaving for the day or on a day the employee is not scheduled to work, and such work shall be paid a minimum of one (1) hour. An employee who is called back to work shall be reimbursed for mileage. The parties intend that nothing herein shall prevent the parties from dealing with emergencies as they have in past practice.

D. MEAL BREAK

Each Classified Employee working more than four (4) hours per day shall be entitled to an unpaid, duty-free, uninterrupted meal break of at least thirty (30) consecutive minutes.

E. BREAK TIME

During the work day each full-time Classified Employee shall have two (2) periods of fifteen (15) minutes each at no loss in pay for break time. By mutual agreement a Classified Employee and his or her supervisor may agree to consolidate the break periods into one (1) period of thirty (30) consecutive minutes. Part-time Classified Employees working four (4) hours or more shall receive pro-rated break time.

F. BUILDING ACCESS

Any Classified Employee who is required by the Superintendent to perform after-hours work at a District facility shall have access to the facility.

G. HEALTH AND SAFETY ISSUES

Whenever a classified employee is directed to purchase, store, use, transport, or dispose of a hazardous commercial substance, the employer will provide said classified employee with necessary procedures and training. The classified employees shall attend an approved training course before beginning work with hazardous commercial materials on a regular basis. A classified employee working with any hazardous commercial substance shall be provided with the necessary equipment and supplies to work with such materials.

H. ADMINISTERING MEDICATION

(105 ILCS 5/10-22.21B) (from Ch. 122, par. 10-22.21b) Sec. 10-22.21b. Administering medication. (a) In this Section, "asthma action plan" has the meaning given to that term under Section 22-30. (b) To provide for the administration of medication to students. It shall be the policy of the State of Illinois that the administration of medication to students during regular school hours and during school-related activities should be discouraged unless absolutely necessary for the critical health and well-being of the student. **Under no circumstances shall teachers or other non-administrative school employees, except certified school nurses and non-certificated registered professional nurses, be required to administer medication to students.** This Section shall not prohibit a school district from adopting guidelines for self-administration of medication by students that are consistent with this Section and this Code. This Section shall not prohibit any school employee from providing emergency assistance to students.

ARTICLE IV

WORKING ASSIGNMENTS AND VACANCIES

A. JUST CAUSE

1. A Classified Employee shall be on probation during the first two (2) years of his or her employment in the District. At its option the District may extend the probationary period for an additional two (2) years. Each Classified Employee in the employ of the employer on the date this Agreement is executed shall be deemed non-probationary for so long as he or she shall remain in the continuous service of the employer, notwithstanding whether or not such employee has completed the requisite two (2) or four (4) year probationary period.
2. The Board reserves the authority to discipline non-probationary Classified Employees including suspension without pay. No non-probationary Classified Employee may be dismissed without just cause. No disciplinary suspension without pay of any Classified Employee shall exceed twenty (20) working days except that the employer may suspend a Classified Employee indefinitely when the suspension without pay is in conjunction with dismissal proceedings. Suspension without pay shall not be grievable as to procedure or substance and shall be at the sole discretion of the Board. Classified Employees who may be suspended without pay shall have the right to a hearing and appeal before the Board.

B. PERSONNEL FILE

The District shall maintain a single personnel file for each bargaining unit employee. Each employee may examine the non-confidential contents of his or her personnel file during regular business hours. A representative of the administration shall be present during any file inspection. Each employee may upon request receive from the District without charge one (1) copy of all non-confidential material contained in his or her file. Each employee may submit material to the employer which upon the employee's request shall be added to the employee's personnel file. No disciplinary or material criticizing the employee's performance shall be added to an employee's personnel file without the employee's knowledge and affording the classified employee the opportunity to submit such material.

C. REIMBURSEMENTS

The policies of the Illinois State Board of Education (ISBE) shall determine the reimbursement rate for all Classified Employees for mileage, meals, and lodging.

D. SENIORITY AND REDUCTION-IN-FORCE

1. Categories of Positions

For purposes of determining seniority among the support staff in the bargaining unit, the following categories of positions shall exist within the meaning of School Code Section 10-23.5:

- a. Cook
- b. Custodian
- c. Certified teacher aide
- d. Non-certified aide (lunchroom, library, locker worker)
- e. Bus driver
- f. Secretary
- g. Transportation attendant
- h. Maintenance director
- i. Bus mechanic/transportation assistant
- j. Health care aide

2. Seniority Definition

Seniority shall be defined as the length of continuous service measured from the first day of employment in AlWood Community Unit School District No. 225.

3. Seniority Measure

For purposes of start of service, end of service or breaks in service, seniority shall be measured in terms of days of service; and in no case shall seniority be measured in terms of a unit of time smaller than a day.

4. Seniority Accrual

Seniority shall not accrue during any unpaid leave of absence of ninety (90) consecutive employment days or more.

5. Seniority – Loss Of

All seniority shall be lost upon resignation, retirement, dismissal for cause or upon layoff when recall rights expire.

6. Seniority – Ties

If two (2) or more classified employees have the same seniority, ties shall be broken in order of the following:

- a. the classified employee working the greater number of hours per week, then
- b. the classified employee with the greatest total District experience, and then
- c. the drawing of lots.

7. Reduction In Force

Employees affected by reduction in force shall be honorably dismissed by seniority within category of position. Reductions shall be in accordance with School Code Section 10-23.5. These categories shall be cook, custodian, certified teacher aide, bus driver, secretary, non-certified aide (lunchroom, library, locker worker), transportation attendant, maintenance director, bus mechanic transportation assistant, and health aide.

8. Recall

If the Board has any vacancies for the following school term or within one (1) calendar year from the beginning of the following school term, the positions thereby becoming available within a specific category of position shall be tendered to the employees so removed or dismissed from the category or position, so far as they are qualified to hold such positions on the date of recall. Employees shall be recalled in reverse order of layoff. If such an employee in the recall pool is tendered a recall offer by certified or registered mail addressed to the employee's last known address for a position for which the employee is qualified, the employee shall respond in writing either accepting or rejecting the offer so that the school district receives the employee's response within fourteen (14) days of the postmark on the recall notice. Failure to respond within the designated time period shall be deemed rejection of the offer. Copies of recall notices shall be mailed to the Association President at the same time they are sent to the employee.

9. Seniority List – Support Staff

On or before February 1 of each year, in consultation with the Association, the Board shall develop a support staff seniority list. The list shall be categorized pursuant to the categories of positions set forth in Article IV, Section A, Categories of Positions, hereinabove. Each employee shall appear on each seniority list for each position to which said employee is currently assigned.

10. Seniority List Placement and Removal

If an employee is removed from a particular category of position, the employee shall be removed from the seniority list in said category of position as of date of removal. If an employee is assigned to a new category of position, the employee shall carry all said employee's seniority to such new category of position.

Example:

- a. A bus driver-custodian with seven (7) years' seniority is reassigned as a cook. There is no break in service. The employee shall be removed from the bus driver and custodian seniority lists and shall be placed on the cook seniority list and thereon credited with seven (7) years' seniority.
- b. An employee employed one-half (1/2) time as a bus driver and one-half (1/2) time as a custodian for seven (7) consecutive calendar years is reassigned as a full-time custodian. The employee shall appear on the custodian seniority list and thereon be credited with seven (7) years' seniority.

11. Seniority List Order

The seniority list developed pursuant to the above shall list the employee with the greatest seniority in each category of position first, followed by the other employees in each category of position in order of seniority.

12. Seniority List Exceptions

The Association or any employee shall have thirty (30) days from February 1 of each year to file exceptions to the seniority list. Failure to file exceptions shall be deemed approval of the list. Exceptions shall be filed with the Superintendent of Schools and shall state the specific reason for the exception.

ARTICLE V

EMPLOYEE EVALUATION

A. PURPOSE OF EVALUATIONS

The primary purpose of Classified Employee evaluation shall be the improvement of job skills, and all evaluations shall be conducted in good faith to this end and in accordance with the provisions of this Agreement.

B. PROCEDURES

1. Each Classified Employee's job performance shall be evaluated by a qualified administrator.
2. Each Classified Employee shall be evaluated at least annually during his or her first three (3) years of employment and at least once every two (2) years thereafter. On-site observations of at least twenty (20) minutes shall precede the evaluation of any instructional aide. The evaluation forms shall be applicable to the job classification and will consider work quality, promptness, attendance, reliability, conduct, judgment, cooperation and other relevant factors.
3. The administration shall provide a copy of the completed evaluation to the Classified Employee and shall provide an opportunity to discuss it. The original evaluation should be signed by the Classified Employee and filed with the Superintendent; however, any signature shall mean only that the Classified Employee has read the evaluation and received a copy. A post-observation conference shall be held between the evaluator and the Classified Employee to discuss the written evaluation and to arrive at mutual goals for job improvement. If areas of performance are determined to be unsatisfactory, the evaluator shall provide the Classified Employee with recommendations in remediating such areas, if remediable.
4. The Classified Employee may submit a written response that shall be attached to the evaluation and placed in his/her personnel file.

C. FREQUENCY OF EVALUATIONS

Classified Employees shall be given additional evaluations if requested by the Classified Employee; nothing shall be construed to limit the number of formal evaluations of Classified Employee performance deemed necessary by the Administration.

ARTICLE VI

LEAVES

A. SICK LEAVE

At the beginning of each work year, each full-time employee shall be granted fifteen (15) days sick leave without loss of pay for years 1 – 10, sixteen (16) days for years 11 – 15, seventeen (17) days for years 16 – 19 and eighteen (18) days for 20+ years. These days shall be in addition to an employees accumulated sick leave from the previous year, which shall be allowed to accumulate up to three hundred seventy-four (374) days. Sick leave may be used in accordance with Section 24-6 of The School Code (see Appendix 4). A teacher may use up to eight weeks of sick leave for maternity without regard to actual disability so long as the leave commences upon a doctor's

order or at delivery of the child, whichever comes first. Additional paid sick leave up to 8 weeks upon a doctor's note. Part-time employee sick leave shall be pro-rated.

B. SICK LEAVE STATEMENT

At the beginning of each year, the Employer shall furnish each Classified Employee with a written statement setting forth the total accumulated sick leave credit of said Classified Employee.

C. SICK LEAVE BANK

Catastrophic illness/emergency sick leave in excess of accumulated days shall be granted according to the following procedures:

1. Initial requests shall be screened and approved or rejected by the A.E.A Executive Committee.
2. Approved requests shall be screened and approved or rejected by the Board of Education.
3. Additional sick leave days granted shall not exceed the number of days equal to one-half (1/2) day or 15 days, whichever is less per certified staff member.
4. Classified Employees shall be assessed at a rate of one-half (1/2) day per Classified Employee for a granted emergency leave.
5. Days assessed but not used shall not be reinstated to the staff but banked for use at any future time that requests for emergency sick leave are approved.
6. Additional sick leave granted shall adhere to the following procedure:
 - a. Banked sick leave shall be used first;
 - b. Additional sick leave shall be secured through assessments; and
 - c. Additional sick leave shall never exceed a number equivalent to one-half (1/2) the number of Classified Employee.
7. All assessments shall be made from all Classified Employees or no assessments shall be made.
8. Upon retirement, certified staff may donate the balance of, or a portion thereof, of his/her unused sick leave to the bank.

D. PERSONAL LEAVE

Each Classified Employee shall be entitled to three (3) personal leave days per school year to be used at his/her discretion subject to the following conditions:

1. Classified Employees should apply for personal leave as far in advance as possible in any given situation.
2. The administration may require justification of the short notice when application is made less than five (5) working days prior to the date of the requested leave.
3. Personal leave may be used on the day immediately preceding or following a school holiday or vacation or during the first or last ten (10) Employee employment days only with the approval of the Superintendent and the building Principal.

Unused personal leave may accumulate to a maximum of five (5) personal leave days. After the maximum accumulation of five (5) personal leave days, unused personal leave days shall automatically transfer to sick leave.

E. COURT LEAVE

Any Classified Employee called for jury duty or subpoenaed to testify in a child abuse proceeding shall lose no pay or benefits for such time. Daily rates received for such duties shall be reimbursed to the District for those working days when the Classified Employee is absent.

F. BEREAVEMENT LEAVE

The Board shall allow up to four (4) days of leave without loss of pay. Leave shall be granted upon the death of a member of the immediate family or close friend. Bereavement leave need not be successive days. Such bereavement leave shall include leave for any business-related responsibilities related directly to the death. Further, such leave shall not reduce the total number of accumulated sick leave days or personal days. If additional time is needed for the death of an immediate family member, the employee must secure the Superintendent's approval. If such a request is granted, the employee may be given up to two additional days.

1. The immediate family (as defined in Section 24-6 of the School Code) of the Employee's spouse; and
2. Aunts, uncles, nieces, nephews and first cousins of the Employee or his/her spouse.

G. UNPAID LEAVE

The Board of Education, upon recommendation of the Superintendent, may grant any Classified Employee an unpaid leave of up to three (3) semesters for child care, or such other purposes and upon such other terms and conditions as may be determined by the Employer.

The Employer shall grant an unpaid child-rearing leave of absence upon the birth or adoption of a child to any Classified Employee who requests such leave in accordance with the general terms and conditions set forth below. Nothing in this provision requires any Classified Employee to request an unpaid leave of absence for child-rearing purposes. It is understood that pregnancy shall be treated like any other disability with respect to use of sick leave.

Unless waived by the Employer, the following shall apply to all unpaid leaves:

1. All requests for leaves shall be made to the Superintendent or designee at least sixty (60) calendar days prior to the beginning of such leave. The application shall indicate the requested starting and ending dates of the leave, when possible, and the reasons for the request.
2. Any request for a leave based upon personal medical reasons shall be accompanied by a physician's statement indicating the nature, anticipated extent, and duration of the medical disability. A physical examination may be required of Classified Employees returning from leaves for personal medical reasons. Any medical examination requiring a Board-designated physician shall be at the Employer's expense.
3. As a condition of any unpaid leave, a Classified Employee must notify the Superintendent or designee in writing of his/her intent to return at least sixty (60) days prior to the expiration of the leave, or by March 1 if the leave, extends to the end of the school year.
4. With the consent of the carrier, a Classified Employee on leave may maintain insurance benefits by making timely payments of all premiums due to the Unit Office.
5. Any Classified Employee who has been employed ninety (90) or more days of the school year, or the equivalent of one (1) semester, shall be entitled to advancement on the salary schedule, if one exists, as the Employee would have had if the leave had not been granted. Classified Employees shall lose no accumulated benefits as a result of such leave.
6. Reinstatement at the termination of such leave will be to the Classified Employee's former position or its equivalent.

ARTICLE VII

COMPENSATION AND RELATED PROVISIONS

A. SALARY SCHEDULE

See Appendix 1 (\$1.00 increase per hour each year for four (4) years)

B. BONUSES

- After 5 years of service - \$500
- After 10 years of service - \$1,000
- After 15 years of service - \$1,500
- After 20 years of service - \$2,000
- After 25 years of service - \$2,500
- After 30 years of service - \$3,000
- After 35 years of service - \$3,500
- After 40 years of service - \$4, 000

** For the 2022 – 2023 school year, all classified employees who have at least five years experience will receive the bonus appropriate to their years of service. After the 2022 – 2023 school year, bonuses will follow the agreed-upon schedule.

D. RATE OF PAY

The daily rate of pay shall be determined by multiplying the Employee's straight time hourly rate by the number of hours in the Employee's regular work day.

E. OVERTIME AND COMPENSATORY TIME

Overtime and compensatory time shall be in accordance with the Fair Labor Standards Act.

All employees required to complete GCN training will be paid \$12.00 per required module completed.

Employees will be paid for their regular work hours on days when school is dismissed early due to weather or other emergencies.

F. BUS DRIVER EXTRA TRIPS AND OVERTIME

A bus driver shall begin work fifteen (15) minutes before the beginning of any bus run and work for fifteen (15) minutes after any bus run for the express purpose of clean up, gassing the bus when necessary and performing a safety inspection of his/her bus. This thirty (30) minutes shall count as part of the work day. Their morning and afternoon shifts will be completed when the runs are completed. If a bus driver's total time exceeds forty (40) hours per week, he/she shall be paid overtime and shall not be eligible for compensatory time. All overtime hours must be approved in advance of the time worked by the Superintendent or designee.

Extra trips shall be compensated at a minimum base rate of forty dollars (\$40.00) for the first two hours of a trip. The rate shall be fifteen dollars (\$15.00) per hour for each hour thereafter with a minimum of two (2) hours per trip. Extra trips shall be offered to bus drivers on a rotating basis and shall be on a voluntary basis. If there are no volunteers, the least senior bus driver on a rotating basis may be assigned to an extra trip. Both travel and down time shall be counted in determining compensation for extra trips.

If a bus driver is a coach, extra trips shall be compensated at a minimum base rate of fifty dollars (\$50) for trips up to 8 hours in length and one hundred dollars (\$100) for trips of more than 8 hours in length. In addition, practice trips should be compensated in the same manner as a normal bus driver.

If a driver/aide reports to work and starts their duties, and then a route is canceled due to weather, lack of student attendance, or circumstances beyond their control, the employee will be paid for a minimum of 2 hours (if their normal schedule would have been more than 2 hours).

If a trip is canceled after a bus driver is scheduled for an extra trip, he/she shall be compensated for a two (2) hour minimum trip base rate, if the bus driver notification occurs less than ninety (90) minutes prior to departure for all sports.

Substitute bus drivers who ride with the regular route driver to learn the route will be paid at a rate of whatever the current minimum wage is at the time.

Whenever a bus driver is assigned an extra trip in lieu of his or her regular route, the bus driver shall receive regular route pay and the extra trip pay.

G. LEAP/ECE/PRE-SCHOOL ROUTE

The LEAP/ECE/Pre-School route shall be paid for the 2000-2001 school year at eighty percent (80%) of the rate for the a.m.-p.m. bus routes. The percentage shall be adjusted annually so as to accurately mirror the time relationship in pay rate between the LEAP/ECE/Pre-School route and an average regular bus route.

H. PAY DAY

Salary checks will be issued on the 15th and 30th of each month with the first check of the contract year issued on August 30th. If the dates fall on a weekend or holiday, checks shall be issued and dated on the preceding day. Bus drivers will be paid bi-monthly for extra trips. Records of trips made by bus drivers shall be submitted to the unit office by the 5th for payment on the 15th and by the 20th for payment on the 30th. A Classified Employee terminating employment will have his or her final paycheck adjusted for any unused, earned vacation credit. Classified Employees are paid for all earned vacation. Classified Employees will receive their final pay on the next regular payday following the date of termination, except that a Classified Employee dismissed due to a reduction in force shall receive his or her final paycheck on or before the third (3rd) business day following the last day of employment.

I. INTERNAL SUBSTITUTION

In the event a Classified Employee volunteers or is required to act as a temporary substitute he or she shall be paid at the rate of the replaced Employee or his or her own rate whichever is higher.

J. HEALTH INSURANCE

The district shall provide a comprehensive health, major medical, dental and vision insurance plan for all full-time Classified Employees. Life insurance shall be included in the plan. The District shall pay 100% of the single premium.

K. PAYROLL DEDUCTIONS

Classified Employees may request payroll deductions for such things as annuities, credit union, miscellaneous insurance coverage, and Association dues. Association dues shall be equally deducted from the first eighteen (18) checks. All other deductions from salary shall be taken equally to the extent possible.

L. JOB TRAINING

Whenever any Classified Employee is required by the Board to attend any training for the purpose of maintenance or improvement of job skills, he or she shall be reimbursed at the district policy rate and subject to policy restrictions for the cost of registration, transportation, motel/hotel and meals, however, in no case, shall reimbursement be more generous than reimbursement provided to teachers under the provisions of the Professional Development clause in the certified contract.

M. REIMBURSEMENT FOR EXPENSES

If the Board requires an Employee to incur meal, lodging or registration expenses, Registration fees, banquet, other meals, mileage, and lodging will be reimbursed in accordance with the policies of the Illinois State Board of Education (ISBE) under the following stipulations:

If the Classified Employee uses his/her own vehicle, mileage will be reimbursed at the published ISBE mileage rate (see Appendix 2). Mileage shall be computed from home or school, whichever is less. If the Employee uses a school vehicle, mileage will be computed at the same rate and deducted from the allowable reimbursement amount.

If the conference is over one hundred (100) miles away, or the conference involves more than one (1) day and is more than fifty (50) miles away, the Classified Employee may be reimbursed for lodging at the ISBE rate (see Appendix 2).

Classified Employees directed to attend conferences or taking students to competitions, meetings, or workshops shall not be considered on professional leave and shall be reimbursed in full for registration fees, mileage, and lodging.

The school will reimburse all employees for required immunizations, permits, and licenses as approved by the superintendent

N. LIABILITY INSURANCE

The Board shall abide by the provisions of 105 ILCS 5/20.20 which provides indemnity and immunity for school Employees.

O. VACATION

Full-time twelve (12) month custodians, full time twelve (12) month bus drivers and full-time bus mechanics (full time in each case requiring a regularly assigned forty (40) hour work week) shall be entitled to paid vacation as follows:

after one year through five years..... twelve (12) working days
after six yearseighteen (18) working days

Vacation time shall be scheduled in advance with the employer and shall require the approval of the employer which approval shall not be unreasonably withheld. Vacation days earned in one year shall be used by the end of the following fiscal year except that one week may be carried over to the next fiscal year so that one (1) to five (5) year employees may accumulate three (3) weeks of vacation and five (5) years employees may accumulate four (4) weeks of vacation provided, however, that no employee shall take more than three (3) weeks of vacation at any one time. Classified Employees resigning or whose employment is terminated shall be entitled to reimbursement for unused vacation days.

P. HOLIDAYS

Full-time twelve (12) month Employees who are employed as custodians, maintenance director and bus mechanic shall receive the following thirteen (13) paid holidays: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Day, President's Day, Good Friday, Memorial Day, Fourth of July, Labor Day, Veteran's Day, Thanksgiving Day, Day after Thanksgiving, Christmas Eve Day, Christmas Day, and New Year's Eve Day. Full time ten (10) month secretaries shall receive twelve (12) paid holidays: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Day, President's Day, Good Friday, Memorial Day, Labor Day, Veteran's Day, Thanksgiving Day, Day after Thanksgiving, Christmas Eve Day, Christmas Day, and New Year's Eve Day.

ARTICLE VIII

GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE

A. DEFINITIONS

A grievance shall be any claim by a Classified Employee or the A.E.A. that there has been a violation, misinterpretation, or misapplication of the terms of this Agreement.

B. BASIC PRINCIPLES

1. All time limits consist of school days, except that when a grievance is submitted less than five (5) days before the close of the current school term, the time limit shall consist of all week days in order that the matters may be resolved before the close of the school term or as soon as thereafter is possible. School days for purposes of the grievance procedure shall mean teacher employment days.
2. Every individual covered by this Agreement or the A.E.A. shall have the right to present grievances in accordance with these procedures.
3. Failure of the individual or the A.E.A. to act on any grievance within the prescribed time limits will act as a bar to any further appeal and an administrator's failure to give a decision within the time limits shall permit the grievant to proceed to the next step. The time limits, however, may be extended by mutual agreement.
4. It is agreed that any investigation or other handling or processing of any grievance a Classified Employee or A.E.A. shall be conducted so as to result in minimal interference with the instructional program and related work activities of the Classified staff.
5. The Employer shall immediately inform the A.E.A. of any grievance.

6. The Board acknowledges the right of the grievance representative to participate in the processing of a grievance at any level.
7. When a Classified Employee chooses not to be represented by the Association, the Association shall reserve the right to have its representative present to state its views at any stage of the grievance procedure.
8. The Board of Education agrees that the administration will cooperate with the Association's or individual's investigation of any grievance.

C. PROCEDURES

Step One

An attempt shall be made to resolve any grievance in informal, verbal discussion between complainant and his/her Principal and/or Superintendent.

Step Two

If the grievance cannot be resolved informally, the individual or A.E.A. shall file the grievance in writing and, at a mutually agreeable time, discuss the matter with the Principal. The written grievance shall state the nature of the grievance, shall note the specific Agreement item of the grievance, and shall state the remedy requested. The filing of the formal, written grievance at the second step must be within fifteen (15) days from the date of the occurrence of the event giving rise to the grievance. The Principal shall make a decision on the grievance and communicate it in writing to the Classified Employee, A.E.A., and the Superintendent within five (5) days after receipt of the grievance.

Step Three

In the event a grievance has not been satisfactorily resolved at the second step, the grievant or the Association shall file, within five (5) school days of the Principal's written decision at the second step, a copy of the grievance with the Superintendent. Within ten (10) school days after such written grievance is filed, the grievant and the Superintendent shall meet to resolve the grievance. The Superintendent shall file an answer within ten (10) school days of the third step grievance meeting and communicate it in writing to the grievant, the A.E.A., and the Principal.

Step Four

If a satisfactory response is not received from the Superintendent, the A.E.A. may, within ten (10) school days, present the grievance to the Board of Education who shall respond at the next scheduled meeting of the Board of Education provided the grievance is presented at least three (3) days prior to the scheduled meeting.

Step Five

If the Association is not satisfied with the disposition of the grievance at Step Four or the time limits expire without the issuance of the Superintendent's written reply, the Association may submit the grievance to final and binding arbitration under the Voluntary Labor Arbitration Rules of the American Arbitration Association, which shall act as the administrator of the proceedings. If a demand for arbitration is not filed within thirty (30) days of the date for the Step Four answer, the grievance shall be deemed withdrawn.

Neither the Board of Education nor the Association shall be permitted to assert any grounds before the arbitrator that have not previously been disclosed to the other party prior to Step Five.

The arbitrator shall not alter the provisions of the Agreement. His authority shall be strictly limited to deciding only the issues presented to him in writing by the School District and the Association and his decision must be based only upon his interpretation of the meaning or application of the express relevant language of the Agreement.

Each party shall bear full costs for its representation in the grievance procedure.

If either party requests a transcript of the proceedings, that party shall bear full costs for that transcript. If both parties order a transcript, the costs of the two transcripts shall be equally divided between the Board and the Association.

Each party shall share equally the cost of the arbitrator and the American Arbitration Association costs.

D. RELEASED TIME

If the resolution of a grievance requires a Classified Employee or Association representative to be released from that Employee's regular assignment for the investigation or processing of a grievance, the Classified Employee or Association representative shall be released without loss of pay or benefits. Both parties agree that no more than three (3) witnesses shall be called to testify to any specific item and no more than a total of nine (9) witnesses can be called in any grievance hearing.

E. FILING OF MATERIALS

All records related to a grievance shall be filed separately from the personnel files of the Classified Employees.

F. GRIEVANCE WITHDRAWAL

A grievance may be withdrawn at any level without establishing precedent.

G. REPRISALS

No reprisals of any kind shall be taken by the Board or the Administration against the Classified Employee because of his/her participation in this grievance procedure.

ARTICLE IX

FRAMEWORK FOR COLLECTIVE BARGAINING

A. BARGAINING NOTIFICATION

The parties shall commence bargaining for a successor agreement no earlier than January 1 and no later than July 1 of the expiration year of this Agreement.

B. AUTHORITY OF REPRESENTATIVES

Each party shall select its own representatives. The parties mutually pledge that their representatives will be clothed with all necessary power and authority to make proposals, consider proposals, and make concessions in the course of negotiations.

C. OFFICIAL COPIES

There shall be two (2) signed copies of any final Agreement. One (1) copy shall be retained by the Employer and one (1) copy shall be retained by the Association.

D. PRINTING OF CONTRACT, COSTS, AND DISTRIBUTION

Within thirty (30) days after the Agreement is signed, copies of this Agreement shall be printed at the expense of the Employer and presented to each bargaining unit member. In addition, the Employer shall provide the Association with five (5) copies of the Agreement without charge to the Association.

E. CONTRACTUAL AMENDMENTS

The parties may modify or amend this Agreement by mutual consent. Such changes shall not be effective until they are reduced to writing, ratified, and signed by the parties as an amendment to this contract.

ARTICLE X

EFFECT OF AGREEMENT AND DURATION

A. BOARD POLICY, EMPLOYER RIGHTS

The Employer agrees that no Board policy shall be implemented which conflicts with the terms of this Agreement. The Employer retains its statutory rights to manage the school district.

B. SEVERABILITY

1. If any provision of this Agreement or any application of this Agreement to any Classified Employee or to any group of Classified Employees is held to be contrary to law by a court of competent jurisdiction, then such provision or application shall not be deemed valid and subsisting, except to the extent permitted by law, but all other provisions or applications shall continue in full force and effect.
2. The provision shall remain in full force and effect until a court decision has been reached with respect to the legality, validity, or enforceability of such provision.

C. NO STRIKE OBLIGATION

The Association, as sole and exclusive bargaining representative for all full-time and part-time certificated or professional non-supervisory personnel, agrees that, during the term of this Agreement and any mutually agreed to extension thereof, they shall not engage in or authorize any concerted strike activity of the bargaining unit. The Employer agrees that, for the duration of this Agreement and any extension thereof, it will not engage in a lockout of its Employees.

D. DURATION

This Agreement shall be effective at 12:00 a.m. on the first Employee work day of the 2022-2023 school term and shall continue in effect until 11:59 p.m. on the day preceding the first teacher workday of the 2026-2027 school term.

SIGNATURES:

DATE: August 15, 2022

BOARD OF EDUCATION
ALWOOD COMMUNITY UNIT SCHOOL DISTRICT NO. 225

By: John R. Barta
BOARD PRESIDENT

By: Mary Hick
BOARD SECRETARY

ALWOOD EDUCATION ASSOCIATION, IEA/NEA

By: Michelle A. Steidl
ASSOCIATION PRESIDENT

By: Dawn Berry
ASSOCIATION SECRETARY

Appendix 1

ALWOOD C.U.S.D. NO. 225 ENTRY-LEVEL NON-CERTIFIED SALARIES 2022-2023

Category	Position	Hourly Rate
Secretarial	Entry Level Secretary	\$13.00 *
Custodial	Entry Level Custodian 1st Shift	\$13.00 *
	Entry Level Custodian 2nd Shift	\$13.25 *
Maintenance Director	Entry Level Maintenance	\$14.00 *
Bus Driver	Entry Level Route Driver	\$20.00 *
	Entry Level Suburban Driver	\$15.00 *
	Entry Level Special Ed Driver	\$14.00 *
Bus Mechanic	Entry Level Mechanic	\$14.00 *
Transport Attendant	Entry Level Transport Attendant	\$13.00 *
Cook	Entry Level Head Cook	\$14.00 *
	Entry Level Regular Cook	\$13.00 *
Aide	Entry Level Aide	\$13.00 *
	Entry Level Supervisor	\$13.00 *
	Entry Level Health Aide	\$15.00 *

* Negotiable based on experience

**ALWOOD C.U.S.D. NO. 225
ENTRY-LEVEL NON-CERTIFIED SALARIES
2023-2024**

Category	Position	Hourly Rate
Secretarial	Entry Level Secretary	\$14.00 *
Custodial	Entry Level Custodian 1st Shift	\$14.00 *
	Entry Level Custodian 2nd Shift	\$14.25 *
Maintenance Director	Entry Level Maintenance	\$15.00 *
Bus Driver	Entry Level Route Driver	\$21.00 *
	Entry Level Suburban Driver	\$16.00 *
	Entry Level Special Ed Driver	\$16.00 *
Bus Mechanic	Entry Level Mechanic	\$15.00 *
Transport Attendant	Entry Level Transport Attendant	\$14.00 *
Cook	Entry Level Head Cook	\$15.00 *
	Entry Level Regular Cook	\$14.00 *
Aide	Entry Level Aide	\$14.00 *
	Entry Level Supervisor	\$14.00 *
	Entry Level Health Aide	\$16.00 *

*** Negotiable based on experience**

**ALWOOD C.U.S.D. NO. 225
ENTRY LEVEL NON-CERTIFIED SALARIES
2024-2025**

Category	Position	Hourly Rate
Secretarial	Entry Level Secretary	\$15.00 *
Custodial	Entry Level Custodian 1st Shift	\$15.00 *
	Entry Level Custodian 2nd Shift	\$15.25 *
Maintenance Director	Entry Level Maintenance	\$16.00 *
Bus Driver	Entry Level Route Driver	\$22.00 *
	Entry Level Suburban Driver	\$17.00 *
	Entry Level Special Ed Driver	\$17.00 *
Bus Mechanic	Entry Level Mechanic	\$16.00 *
Transport Attendant	Entry Level Transport Attendant	\$15.00 *
Cook	Entry Level Head Cook	\$16.00 *
	Entry Level Regular Cook	\$15.00 *
Aide	Entry Level Aide	\$15.00 *
	Entry Level Supervisor	\$15.00 *
	Entry Level Health Aide	\$17.00 *

*** Negotiable based on experience**

**ALWOOD C.U.S.D. NO. 225
ENTRY-LEVEL NON-CERTIFIED SALARIES
2025-2026**

Category	Position	Hourly Rate
Secretarial	Entry Level Secretary	\$16.00 *
Custodial	Entry Level Custodian 1st Shift	\$16.00 *
	Entry Level Custodian 2nd Shift	\$16.25 *
Maintenance Director	Entry Level Maintenance	\$17.00 *
Bus Driver	Entry Level Route Driver	\$23.00 *
	Entry Level Suburban Driver	\$18.00 *
	Entry Level Special Ed Driver	\$18.00 *
Bus Mechanic	Entry Level Mechanic	\$17.00 *
Transport Attendant	Entry Level Transport Attendant	\$16.00 *
Cook	Entry Level Head Cook	\$17.00 *
	Entry Level Regular Cook	\$16.00 *
Aide	Entry Level Aide	\$16.00 *
	Entry Level Supervisor	\$16.00 *
	Entry Level Health Aide	\$18.00 *

*** Negotiable based on experience**

APPENDIX 2

TRAVEL- REIMBURSEMENT RATES

- II. **ACTUAL COST OF ACCOMODATIONS:** (Maximums listed below)
 - A. Cook County - \$175.00 plus tax
 - B. Collar County Areas – \$100.00 plus tax (This encompasses the counties of Will, DuPage, Kane, McHenry and Lake)
 - C. Downstate Areas – \$90.00 plus tax
- II. **TRANSPORTATION EXPENSES:** Automobiles, railroads, airlines, buses, taxicabs, and other usual means of transportation
 - F. Car Miles – reimbursed according to the State Reimbursement Rate
 - G. Railroad – need receipt if over \$10
 - H. Airlines (coach class) – need receipt
 - I. Buses – need receipt if over \$10
 - J. Taxicab – need receipt if fare plus tip exceeds \$10.00
- III. **LIVING EXPENSES:**
 - A. Maximum amounts per meal – if not claiming per diem: Please note if any meal was provided at no cost to you.
 - 1. \$6.00 – Breakfast (leaving before 6:00 AM)
 - 2. \$6.00 – Lunch
 - 3. \$20.00 – Dinner (returning from travel after 7:00 pm or beginning travel prior to 6:30 p.m.)
 - D. Per Diem Allowable: Travel period is overnight in excess of 18 hours. Please be sure to include travel departure and travel return times.
Four quarters per 24-hour period - \$28.00 (\$7.00 per quarter)
(12:00 midnight to 5:59 a.m.; 6:00 a.m. to 11:59 a.m.; 12 noon to 5:59 p.m.; 6:00 p.m. to 11:59 p.m.)
- V. **TOLL FEES:** Are accepted, need receipt if over \$10.00
 - A. **PORTERS:** Are accepted if reasonable in amount
 - B. **POSTAGE:** Original receipts required – regardless of amount
 - E. **MISCELLANEOUS:** Expenses accepted if reasonable, need receipt if over \$10.00

RATE CHANGES

The above rates are subject to change during the duration of this Agreement. The Board shall inform the Association of any changes.